

Alejandro Bernal Cruz

Full-Stack Software Engineer | Tech Lead | DevOps | U.S. Citizen

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Professional Summary

Software Engineer with 6 years hands-on experience in Full-Stack development, AWS infrastructure, Docker, Linux, automation, and security. Rapidly advanced to Acting Lead, successfully leading the tech team and production systems. Fast learner focused on building scalable, reliable, and secure software while mentoring others, documenting and improving processes.

Technical Skills

Programming: Python | TypeScript | JavaScript | Java | C++(Fundamentals)

Databases: MongoDB | PostgreSQL | MySQL

Systems & Infrastructure: Linux | Windows | macOS | Docker | AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, CloudWatch, EventBridge, SES, GuardDuty, IAM)

Development Tools: Node.js | npm | React | Next.js | Git / GitHub | VS Code | GitHub Copilot | pip | pyenv

Soft Skills: Technical Leadership | Quick Learner | HIPAA Compliance | Agile/Scrum | Training | Documentation | Detail Oriented

Work Experience

The Legal Leads (a subsidiary of Express Marketing Solutions, Inc.)

Full-Stack Developer, Tech Lead, HIPAA Compliance Tech Lead

Torrance, CA | November 2024 – April 2026

- Acted as interim Technology Lead for 3 months during the CTO's leave; led the tech team, delegated work, managed priorities, and collaborated with stakeholders to keep all projects on track.
- Independently designed and built a real-time background verification system (Python FastAPI + NDA-protected third-party APIs) used by ~10 agents to verify PII, PHI, and criminal history in sequential steps, reducing verification time from as much as a full day of work down to just 10 minutes per prospect.
- Led the design and implementation of Plaid identity verification, building custom Lightning Web Components and Apex classes with real-time WebSocket updates and selfie checks so the Sales team could confidently confirm prospect identity.
- Developed custom Salesforce Apex automations and service integrations for the intake process across 10+ partner firms, securely handling sensitive client data end-to-end.
- Served as HIPAA Compliance Lead (Technology); trained developers and IT staff, created documentation, and enforced secure data-handling practices across internal and external teams.
- Led the migration of 10+ services from OVH to AWS, including migrating system images from OVH VPS to EC2 instances, securing them with GuardDuty, and setting up CloudWatch for telemetry and custom alerts.
- Migrated custom relays to serverless using AWS Lambda, creating faster and more manageable routes for smaller services without the need for full EC2 instances.
- Set up and secured Passbolt (open-source password manager) with IP whitelisting and firewall rules to safely manage master credentials for the team, all running on a Raspberry Pi 5.

URBAN TXT: Teens Exploring Technology

Junior Developer, Full-Stack Developer, Lead Full-Stack Developer, Instructor

Los Angeles, CA | August 2020 – May 2024

- Owned full-stack development and ongoing maintenance of 7+ MERN applications (landing pages, admin tools, program pages, mobile apps, and the internal "Hustle N'Code" coding platform) supporting 300+ students and staff.
- Built and enhanced key platforms including Hackathon Recruiting and Office Sign-In mobile apps, program pages (Summer, Hackathon, Alumni), and the Hustle N'Code platform where students created and safely shared projects using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Led the summer tech program, guiding students from concept to production as they built and deployed 10–15 startup applications to the Apple App Store and Google Play Store for demo purposes.
- Designed and taught the organization's first Web3 / NFT creation curriculum and game development classes, while also instructing MERN stack, React Native, and web development fundamentals to inspire youth in emerging technologies.
- Created the first international coding curriculum and led TXT's inaugural hybrid hackathon, connecting 90 students in Los Angeles with 30 students from El Salvador and Guatemala in real time on the company's own platform.
- Led technical volunteer orientations and recruitment for university students and tech professionals, training them on the coaching model and MERN stack tools used throughout the programs.
- Performed regular security audits and feature development across all MERN applications while managing deployments, updates, and infrastructure (Linux, Docker, AWS, MongoDB/MySQL).

Education

California State University, Los Angeles - Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | May 2020

Member, Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Object-Oriented Programming, Software Design, Web Development, Database Systems, Operating Systems